

THE FIRST NEW ZEALANDERS

New Zealand was one of the last places on Earth to be inhabited by people. The first settlers, the Maori, arrived from Polynesia in about 950. Today, although most Maoris have adopted western lifestyles, their culture lives on in their language, art, and extended family groups. Maoris are represented in the government, and there are moves to ensure that they receive equal opportunities in health care, education, and employment, which have been lacking in the past.



MAORI ART

This neck pendant represents Tiki, one of the Maori gods, and is worn to bring good luck. It is carved from greenstone, a kind of hard jade found on the South Island.

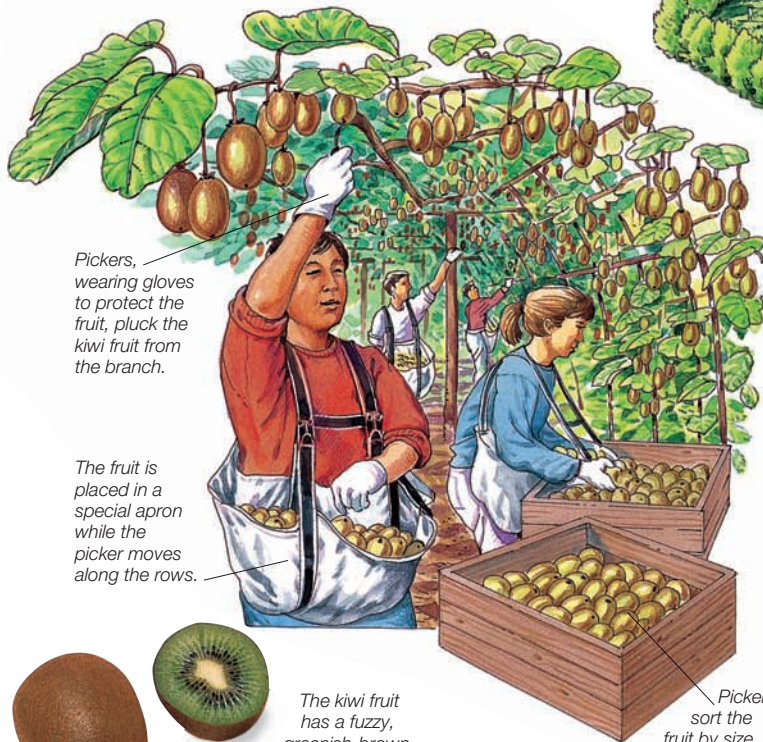


OUTDOOR LIFE

New Zealand's pleasant climate and beautiful countryside make it ideal for outdoor activities. New Zealanders enjoy sports of all kinds, from hiking and mountain climbing to canoeing, yachting, and rugby. The country's rugby team, the All Blacks, are shown in action above. Many tourists visit New Zealand for its outdoor lifestyle, and tourism is now a major source of income.

KIWI FRUIT

The Chinese gooseberry was introduced into New Zealand in about 1900 and was later renamed the kiwi fruit after the country's famous bird. New Zealand is now the world's principal producer and exports kiwi fruit worldwide. This subtropical fruit needs a warm, sunny climate. It is grown in special orchards divided into sections by fences or hedges.

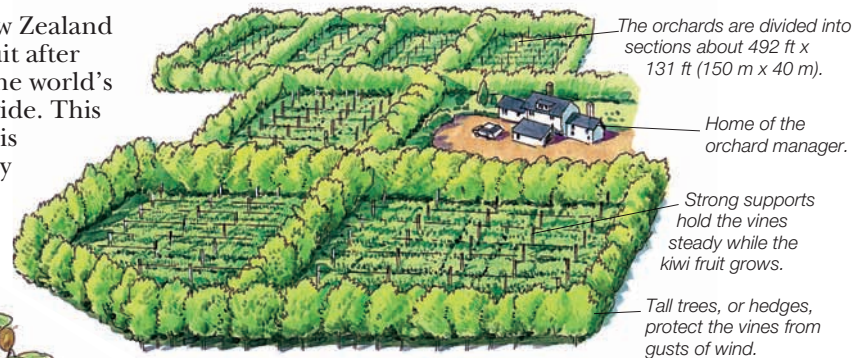


Pickers, wearing gloves to protect the fruit, pluck the kiwi fruit from the branch.

The fruit is placed in a special apron while the picker moves along the rows.



The kiwi fruit has a fuzzy, greenish-brown skin a little like the feathers of the bird after which it is named.



The orchards are divided into sections about 492 ft x 131 ft (150 m x 40 m).

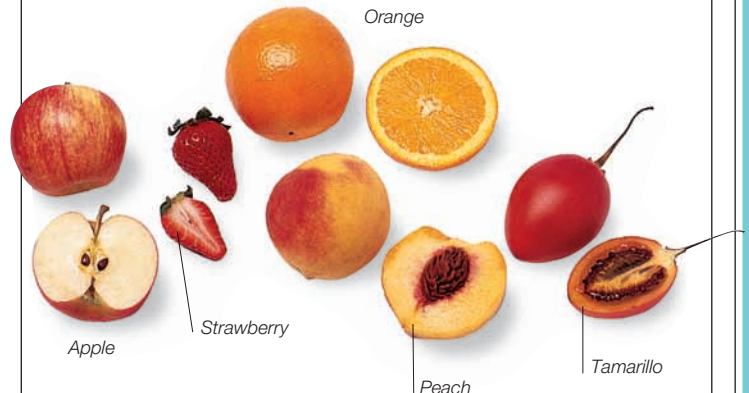
Home of the orchard manager.

Strong supports hold the vines steady while the kiwi fruit grows.

Tall trees, or hedges, protect the vines from gusts of wind.

ORCHARD FRUITS

Because New Zealand lies in the southern hemisphere, it can grow crops when its customers in the north are in the middle of their winter. The main types of fruit, with examples from each group shown below, are seed fruit (apple), berry fruit (strawberry), pit fruit (peach), citrus fruit (orange), and subtropical fruit (tamarillo).



Apple

Strawberry

Peach

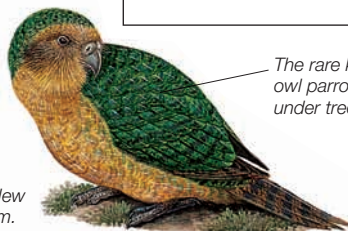
Tamarillo

FLIGHTLESS BIRDS

New Zealand's isolated position has allowed many unique plants and animals to develop there. The most famous are the flightless birds, such as the kakapo and kiwi. These birds lost the ability to fly because they had no enemies and did not need to be able to fly away.



The long-beaked kiwi is New Zealand's national emblem.



The rare kakapo, or owl parrot, nests under tree roots.

Find out more

HYDROELECTRICITY: 108
SETTLING PACIFIC ISLANDS: 257
SHEEP FARMING: 261
VOLCANIC ACTIVITY: 13, 255